



North Coast Salmon Update #8 – 18 Aug 2026

Please note that catch numbers and estimates are preliminary and are subject to review.

The 2026/27 Northern Salmon IFMP is available here: [Northern IFMP](#)

North Coast Troll

Coho and Pink Salmon

The Area F Chinook Salmon ITQ full fleet opening ([FN0760](#)) and the Haida Community Based Chinook opening ([FN0825](#)) started on August 10th. There are currently 83 vessels participating in the main opening with retention of Coho and Pink salmon permitted. Validation is mandatory for all Chinook landings.

An additional 13 vessels are also designated under the Haida CBF troll communal licence including 2 full sized trollers and 11 smaller restricted gear vessels. The CBF opening also includes dual fishing for FSC with mandatory validation of all landings.

Area F Chinook and Coho catches are also sampled for CWT recovery and DNA is collected from Chinook and Coho for GSI analysis. Weekly estimates of effort, catch and releases to August 15th (North Dixon A-B Line opening) are summarized in Table 1 below.

Table 1. 2026 Estimated weekly catch and release by species

WEEK	End Date	Effort	Chinook		Coho		Pink		Sockeye		Chum	
			Kept	Rel.	Kept	Rel.	Kept	Rel.	Kept	Rel.	Kept	Rel.
27	4-Jul	19	0	56	1,266	0	327	0	1	0	0	8
28	11-Jul	58	0	305	4,992	0	1,832	0	9	0	0	40
29	18-Jul	109	0	426	6,477	13	4,267	5	15	0	0	44
30	25-Jul	119	0	474	5,375	7	7,688	6	16	0	0	51
31	1-Aug	118	0	684	5,031	0	9,911	28	28	3	0	69
32	8-Aug	40	0	172	1,849	0	5,874	93	1	1	0	39
33	15-Aug	526	20,550	2,624	5,483	51	6,913	4,261	0	719	0	2,476
Total		989	20,550	4,740	30,474	71	36,812	4,393	70	724	0	2,726

Notes: -Effort reported as vessel-days.

Areas 1 & 2 - Haida Gwaii

Recreational:

Area 1 and 2 (Haida Gwaii) recreational catch estimates (Table 2) are derived from two data sources, including logbook catch reports from the five participating fly-in lodges as well as independent estimates of catch and releases generated by the Haida Fisheries creel program. July creel estimates were based on 1,226 point-of-access interviews recorded at 7 sites. Interview data are used to generate CPUE and fishery activity patterns. Effort estimates are derived from both roving vessel counts and point of access video.

*Table 2. Preliminary Recreational Catch Estimates, Haida Gwaii***2026 Preliminary estimates of recreational fishing catch for Haida Gwaii (Areas 1 and 2W)**

Month	Area	Effort (Boat trips)	Coho	Coho-Rel	Chinook	Chinook-Rel	Pink	Sockeye	Chum	Halibut	Lingcod	Rockfish
June	1	3,596	2,261	246	4,064	8,292	35	11	302	2,123	2,415	1,100
	2W	589	68	0	1,046	1,515	0	0	7	464	1,456	630
June Total		4,185	2,329	246	5,110	9,807	35	11	309	2,587	3,871	1,730
July	1	4,060	8,197	946	4,148	8,550	205	25	305	2,311	2,785	2,482
	2W	850	1,199	126	1,610	2,078	92	0	7	549	1,449	533
July Total		4,910	9,396	1,072	5,758	10,628	297	25	312	2,860	4,234	3,015
TTD (June-July)	1	7,656	10,458	1,192	8,212	16,842	240	36	607	4,434	5,200	3,582
	2W	1,439	1,267	126	2,656	3,593	92	0	14	1,013	2,905	1,163
All Areas		9,095	11,725	1,318	10,868	20,435	332	36	621	5,447	8,105	4,745

Note: Catch estimates are preliminary and subject to revision.

Terminal Salmon Assessments:

Terminal salmon assessments started late last week to assess dominant cycle Pink salmon returns (even years on Haida Gwaii) and the monitoring will continue through September and October to also assess Chum salmon returns. One vessel-based operator will provide 48 days of charter patrol coverage in Area 2E in 2026. In addition, the Haida Fisheries Program will carry out assessments of key watersheds in Skidegate Inlet, Masset Inlet, Naden Harbour and Rennell Sound.

North Coast Chinook Management Plan-AABM Recreational Fisheries

Areas 1, 2, 142, and that portion of Area 101 west of 131 degrees 40.0 minutes West longitude:

- May 29, 2026 to July 31, 2026 - one (1) Chinook per day.
- August 1, 2026 to March 31, 2027 - two (2) Chinook per day.

Area 3 - Nass River

The Nass River Gitwinksihlkw fish wheels have been operating since June 1. In-season run size estimates past the fishwheels are shown in Table 3. The current in-season Total Return to Canada (TRTC) forecast for Sockeye is a point estimate of 358,000, and for Chinook is a point estimate of 18,000.

Table 3. Nass fishwheel in-season run size estimate to August 16, 2026 and historical average cumulative catch (1994-2025) to date.

Year	Sockeye	Chinook	Coho	Steelhead
2026	240,480	9,540	27,412	4,539
1994-2025 Avg.	285,300	18,680	43,700	5,050

Data provided by Nisga'a Fisheries and Wildlife Department (NFWD).

Nass River salmon stock assessment updates from the Nisga'a Fish and Wildlife Department are available by Dropbox [here](#).

Net Fisheries:

Area C:

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Valida

Printed from the Fishery Operations System on July 28, 2026 at 10:15

Canada

Printed from the Fishery Operations System on July 21, 2026 at 14:58

The Nass CSAF fishery catches to date are included in Table 4. Please note that the Nisga'a demonstration fishery is implemented as part of the Individual Sales fishery and catches are reported separately through NFWD weekly updates.



Table 4. Nass Demonstration Fishery catches to August 15, 2026.

Week End	Area	Sockeye Retained
1-Aug	Meziadin	30
8-Aug	Meziadin	1075
15-Aug	Meziadin	1835
Total		2940

Two CSAF Demonstration fisheries targeting Area 3 Pink salmon will not be implemented in 2026.

As occurred in 2023 and 2024, ESSR fishing plans that target the harvestable surplus of Meziadin Sockeye are undergoing evaluation for potential implementation in 2026.

Recreational Fisheries:

Non-Tidal

Recreational fishing for Chinook is closed in the Nass River watershed.

North Coast Chinook Management Plan-ISBM Tidal Recreational Fisheries

Areas 3 to 5, 103 to 105, Subarea 102-1, and that portion of Area 101 east of 131 degrees 40.0 minutes West longitude:

- Effective June 1, 2026 at 00:01 hours to 23:59 hours June 22, 2026 - One (1) Chinook per day.
- Effective June 23, 2026 at 00:01 hours to 23:59 hours July 17, 2026 - Zero (0) Chinook per day.
- Effective July 18, 2026 at 00:01 hours to 23:59 hours July 31, 2026 – One (1) Chinook per day.
- Effective Aug 1, 2026 at 00:01 hours to 23:59 hours March 31, 2027 – Two (2) Chinook per day.

Tidal portion of the Gingolx (Kincolith) River:

- Effective June 23, 2026 at 00:01 hours to 23:59 hours March 31, 2027 - Zero (0) Chinook per day.

Sockeye

Recreational fishing for Sockeye will open in Areas 3, 4 and 5 on July 10, 2026 with a daily limit of four (4).

Meziadin Fishway:

Fishway operations commenced July 1 for the 2026 season. As of August 17, a total of 104,204 Sockeye have been counted through, compared to the mean 1994-2025 cumulative count to date of 116,059 (Table 4). Water levels are at 1.18m (compared to mean 1998-2025 level of 1.23m), and the water temperature is 19.0°C (16.8°C mean 1999-2025).



Table 5. Cumulative Meziadin fishway counts by species to August 17, 2026, compared to historical mean cumulative adult counts to date.

Year	Sockeye	Chinook	Coho	Steelhead
2026	104,204	48	160	0
1994-2025 Avg.	116,059	190	72	0

Historic and 2026 counts are available through:

<http://www.pac.dfo-mpo.gc.ca/fm-gp/northcoast-cotenord/meziadin-eng.html>

Kwinageese Weir:

Kwinageese Weir video enumeration commenced July 20 by NFWD. Counts to August 16 indicate 1115 Sockeye, 318 Chinook, 4 Coho, and 0 Steelhead. Average counts from 2002-2025 compare at 2230 Sockeye, 385 Chinook, 10 Coho, and 0 Steelhead.

Alaska Fisheries

District 101 Gillnet Fishery:

The District 101 (D1) gillnet fishery opened for five days in US SW 33. Catch and effort information is available below (Table 6).

Table 6. Alaska District 101 gillnet harvest and effort (CPUE) for stat week 33 in 2026 and the 10-year average.

Species	District 1 Catch – Week 33 (CPUE)	10-Year Average (CPUE)
Chinook	0 (0)	11 (0.1)
Sockeye	800 (6)	1,753 (14)
Coho	2,000 (16)	1,412 (11)
Pink	60,000 (480)	28,257 (225)
Chum	10,000 (800)	12,297 (98)
Effort (boats)	25	28
Fishing Days	5	4.5

District 104 Seine Fishery:

The District 104 (D4) purse seine fishery opened for two 2-day openings during SW 33 (Table 7).

Table 7. Alaska District 104 seine harvest and effort for start week 33 in 2026.

Opening	Chinook	Sockeye	Coho	Pink	Chum	Boats	Hours
Aug 10-11	1,600	4,000	6,000	480,000	26,000	23	39
Aug 14-15	750	3,000	2,500	155,000	7,000	10	39

More information on Southeast Alaskan fisheries is available here:

<http://www.adfg.alaska.gov/index.cfm?adfg=fishing.main>



Area 4 - Skeena River

Based on results from the Tyee test fishery to August 17, the current run size estimates range from 1.66M-2.65M Skeena sockeye (80% certainty), with a mean (point) estimate of 2.09M (Table 8, Figure 1).

Table 8. 2026 in-season run size estimate probability for Skeena Sockeye as of August 17, 2026.

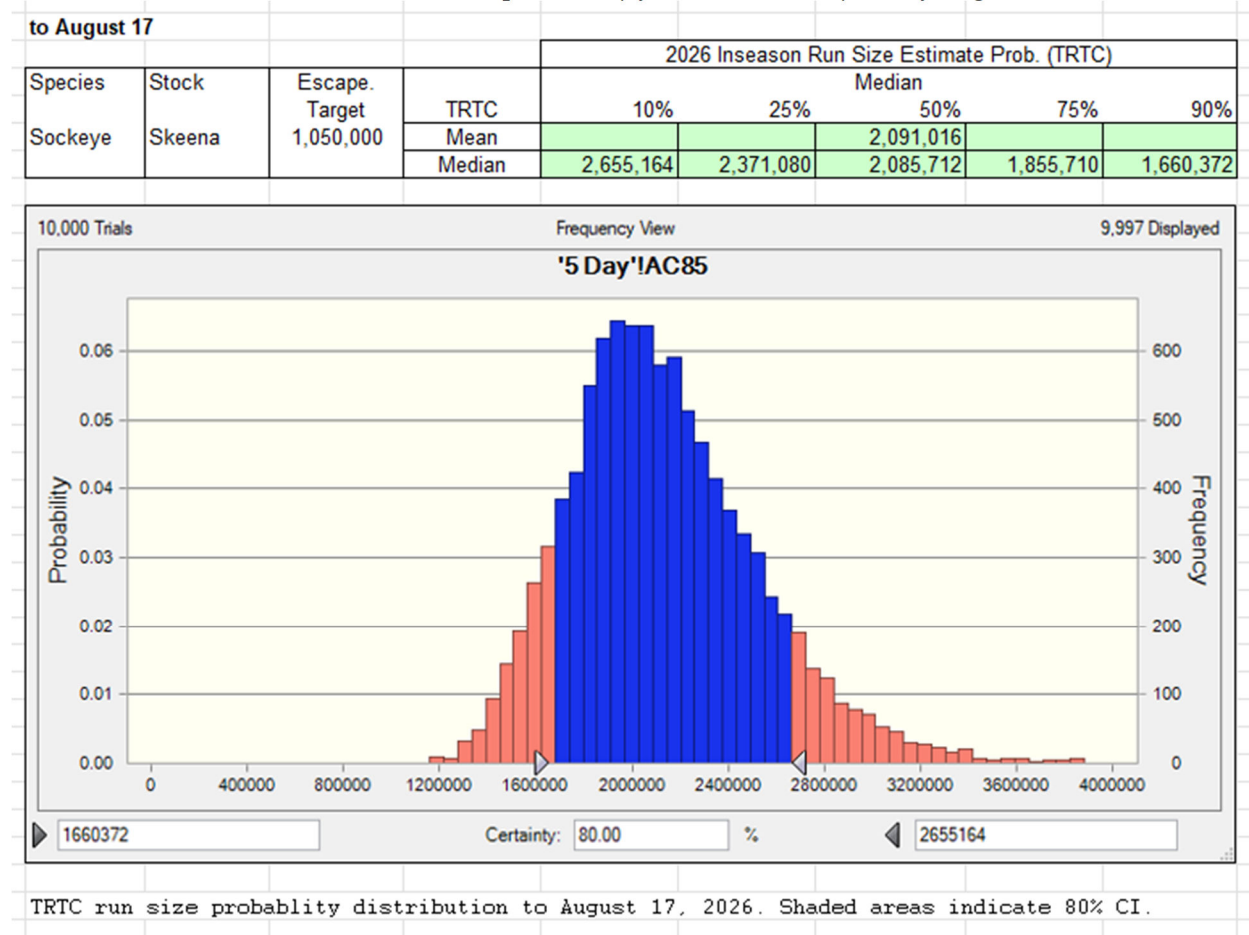


Figure 1. Total return to Canada run size probability distribution to August 17, 2026. Shaded areas indicate 80% CI.

Tyee Test Fishery:

The test fishery began operation on June 10, 2026. As of August 17, the estimated number of large Sockeye past Tyee is 1,621,479. Using average run timing (1985-2025), it is estimated that 94.3% of the run has passed Tyee as of this date.



Table 9. Tyee test fishery cumulative index to August 17, 2026 and ten-year average (2016-2025) to date.

Year	Sockeye	Coho	Pink (even)	Chum	Lg. Chinook	Steelhead
2026	1084.99	27.96	544.85	72.16	103.45	163.81
2025	997.85	23.25	-	20.29	116.43	37.74
2024	1303.13	26.99	715.7	13.89	64.01	121.6
2023	1160.36	74.84	-	31.58	90.01	25.65
2022	2719.34	36.61	384.15	24.3	150.04	54.18
2016-2025 Average	1150.30	35.21	378.97	22.04	92.00	71.43

The 2026 Tyee test fishery daily and cumulative Sockeye escapement estimate data, along with 2026 daily and cumulative escapement indices by species, are available here:

<http://www.pac.dfo-mpo.gc.ca/fm-gp/northcoast-cotenord/skeenatyee-eng.html>

Net Fisheries:

Area C:

Fisheries are closed for the season. Area 4 preliminary catches to July 25, 2026:



Fishery Operations System

Commercial SALMON GILL NET In-Season Estimated Catch-by-Area (Pieces)
for Period 01-Apr-2026 to 28-Jul-2026

Management Area 4

Management Area 4				Report Details by Subarea or Portion												Status	Last Updated
				Sockeye Salmon		Coho Salmon		Pink Salmon		Chum Salmon		Chinook Salmon		Steelhead			
Stat Week	Week of Year	Date	Effort	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel		
		10-Jul	118	12447	0	0	48	0	31	0	28	0	101	0	14	Preliminary Preliminary	24-Jul-2026
		11-Jul	121	13828	0	0	101	0	39	0	13	0	24	0	6		24-Jul-2026
		Total for Week	239	26275	0	0	149	0	70	0	41	0	125	0	20		
		13-Jul	143	21523	0	0	44	214	0	0	121	0	90	0	25	Preliminary Preliminary Preliminary Preliminary	24-Jul-2026
		14-Jul	141	16817	0	0	74	122	0	0	79	0	34	0	18		24-Jul-2026
		16-Jul	160	22578	0	0	16	0	486	0	82	0	76	0	32		24-Jul-2026
		17-Jul	141	22649	0	0	116	1295	0	0	210	0	22	0	141		24-Jul-2026
		Total for Week	575	83567	0	0	250	1631	486	0	492	0	222	0	216		
		19-Jul	166	26925	0	0	147	2087	0	0	184	0	107	0	165	Preliminary Preliminary Preliminary Preliminary Preliminary Preliminary	24-Jul-2026
		20-Jul	167	22479	0	0	46	2299	0	0	107	0	76	0	131		24-Jul-2026
		21-Jul	167	22034	0	0	40	1502	0	0	141	0	37	0	81		24-Jul-2026
		23-Jul	166	25015	0	0	100	3129	0	0	170	0	34	0	101		27-Jul-2026
		24-Jul	166	6321	0	0	62	2677	0	0	132	0	52	0	67		27-Jul-2026
		25-Jul	110	7276	0	0	35	1110	0	0	68	0	6	0	44		27-Jul-2026
		Total for Week	942	110050	0	0	430	12804	0	0	802	0	312	0	589		
	Total for Management Area 4 in Period	1756		219892	0	0	829	14435	556	0	1335	0	659	0	825		

Notes:

1. Consult the applicable Fishery Manager or Biologist as to the status of particular catch estimates.

Area A:

Fisheries are closed for the season. Area 4 ITQ seine catch estimates by opening to August 2:



Fishery Operations System

**Commercial SALMON SEINE In-Season Estimated Catch-by-Area (Pieces)
for Period 01-Apr-2026 to 04-Aug-2026**

Management Area 4

Stat Week	Week of Year	Date	Effort	Sockeye Salmon		Coho Salmon		Pink Salmon		Chum Salmon		Chinook Salmon		Steelhead		Status	Last Updated
				Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel		
		15-Jul	7	1149	0	0	19	236	0	0	49	0	77	0	19	Preliminary	20-Jul-2026
		16-Jul	14	1955	0	0	53	480	0	0	96	0	120	0	41	Preliminary	20-Jul-2026
		17-Jul	17	4756	0	0	129	1109	0	0	172	0	112	0	65	Preliminary	20-Jul-2026
		18-Jul	12	2555	0	0	69	554	0	0	114	0	90	0	41	Preliminary	20-Jul-2026
		Total for Week	50	10415	0	0	270	2379	0	0	431	0	399	0	166		
		19-Jul	11	2165	0	0	67	451	0	0	127	0	83	0	40	Preliminary	20-Jul-2026
		22-Jul	17	12554	0	0	274	6608	0	0	383	0	345	0	119	Preliminary	27-Jul-2026
		23-Jul	20	8800	0	0	288	4394	0	0	348	0	212	0	93	Preliminary	27-Jul-2026
		24-Jul	17	3479	0	0	129	2630	0	0	268	0	102	0	51	Preliminary	27-Jul-2026
		25-Jul	11	2422	0	0	186	2543	0	0	184	0	116	0	62	Preliminary	27-Jul-2026
		Total for Week	76	29420	0	0	944	16626	0	0	1310	0	858	0	365		
		26-Jul	13	4614	0	0	170	4075	0	0	149	0	69	0	56	Preliminary	27-Jul-2026
		29-Jul	14	4907	0	0	307	14516	0	0	499	0	200	0	338	Preliminary	04-Aug-2026
		30-Jul	14	3598	0	0	212	11420	0	0	459	0	122	0	135	Preliminary	04-Aug-2026
		31-Jul	10	3748	17	0	235	15977	0	0	331	0	98	0	160	Preliminary	04-Aug-2026
		01-Aug	9	1414	0	0	249	16124	0	0	297	0	74	0	180	Preliminary	04-Aug-2026
		Total for Week	60	18281	17	0	1173	62112	0	0	1735	0	563	0	869		
		02-Aug	10	2045	0	0	523	14346	0	0	342	0	119	0	301	Preliminary	04-Aug-2026
		Total for Week	10	2045	0	0	523	14346	0	0	342	0	119	0	301		
		Total for Management Area 4 in Period	196	60161	17	0	2910	95463	0	0	3818	0	1939	0	1701		

Notes:

1. Consult the applicable Fishery Manager or Biologist as to the status of particular catch estimates.

CSAF Demonstration and Excess to Salmon Spawning Requirements (ESSR) Fisheries:

Seven CSAF Demonstration fisheries targeting Skeena Sockeye were included in the 2026 IFMP. North Coast Skeena First Nations Stewardship Society (NCSFNSS), Kitsumkalum Band, Kitselas First Nation, Metlakatla First Nation, Lax Kw'alaams Band, Gitxsan First Nation, and Lake Babine Nation fisheries represent access to 22.75% of the Canadian Commercial Allowable Catch, further divided by geographic access and proponent.

Area 4 marine Demonstration fisheries were closed for the season following the last opening on July 31. Preliminary catch information for the season has been summarized by week and area and included below (Table 10).

Table 10. Area 4 CSAF demonstration fishery catches and effort to August 4.

Week End	Area	Effort (# of boats)	Sockeye Retained	Pink Retained
11-Jul	4-9, 4-12, 4-15	15	2356	0
18-Jul	4-5 & 4-9	5	1926	0
18-Jul	4-12	20	3231	0
18-Jul	4-15	10	2076	0
25-Jul	4-5, 4-12, 4-15	12	3619	577
1-Aug	4-5 & 4-9	7	1588	0
1-Aug	4-12	15	3251	92
1-Aug	4-15	7	2018	0
Total		91	20065	669



In-river Skeena sockeye directed demonstration fisheries began in the lower Skeena River on July 15 and closed early last week following a 1 week migration delay from the marine fisheries. Preliminary catch information for the season has been summarized by week in Table 11.

Table 11. Skeena River CSAF demonstration fishery catches and effort.

Week End	Area	Sockeye Retained	Pink Retained
18-Jul	Lower Skeena	400	2
25-Jul	Lower Skeena	1151	1
1-Aug	Lower Skeena	811	0
8-Aug	Lower Skeena	1557	0
15-Aug	Lower Skeena	223	0
Total		4142	3

CSAF demonstration fisheries in the mid-Skeena were opened in the first week of August, with very limited harvest to date due to low observed abundance. More information will be included in the next update.

Two ESSRs in the Skeena River watershed were included in the 2026 IFMP: Babine Sockeye (Lake Babine Nation) and Bulkley River Pink salmon (Office of the Wet'suwet'en).

The Bulkley River Pink salmon fishery began August 7 in Witset Canyon. To date, 483 fish have been harvested.

Recreational Fisheries:

Non-Tidal

Recreational fishing for Chinook started closed in the Skeena River watershed and all rivers and lakes flowing into PFMA 3 to 6, excluding the Kitimat River.

Recreational fishing for Sockeye on the Skeena River mainstem was reduced to 2 per day on August 17, 2026 (FN0868).

Recreational fishing for Sockeye on the Babine River was closed on August 17, 2026 (FN0869). Babine Lake remains open to 2 Sockeye per day.

North Coast Chinook Management Plan-ISBM Tidal Recreational Fisheries

Areas 3 to 5, 103 to 105, Subarea 102-1, and that portion of Area 101 east of 131 degrees 40.0 minutes West longitude:

- Effective June 1, 2026 at 00:01 hours to 23:59 hours June 22, 2026 - One (1) Chinook per day.
- Effective June 23, 2026 at 00:01 hours to 23:59 hours July 17, 2026 - Zero (0) Chinook per day.



- Effective July 18, 2026 at 00:01 hours to 23:59 hours July 31, 2026 – One (1) Chinook per day.
- Effective Aug 1, 2026 at 00:01 hours to 23:59 hours March 31, 2027 – Two (2) Chinook per day.

Tidal portion of the Gingolx (Kincolith) River:

- Effective June 23, 2026 at 00:01 hours to 23:59 hours March 31, 2027 - Zero (0) Chinook per day.

Sockeye

Recreational fishing for Sockeye will open in Areas 3, 4 and 5 on July 10, 2026 with a daily limit of four (4).

Area 3 and 4 Creel Survey

July Summary

The North Coast Skeena First Nations Stewardship Society began their creel survey operations in May of 2026. In July of 2026 they performed 697 interviews totalling 2,437 anglers with a reported catch of 424 Chinook and 2,171 Coho. These numbers are expanded to produce a catch (kept) estimate of 2,051 Chinook and 13,667 Coho.

Kitwanga Weir:

Gitanyow Fisheries Authority (GFA) commenced operations of the Kitwanga River Adult Salmon Enumeration Facility on July 21 for the season, later than typical due to high water levels. To August 13, GFA has counted 4 Sockeye, 482 Chinook, 59 Pink, 35 Chum, and 11 Coho through the weir. Updates provided by the Gitanyow Fisheries Authority are available through: www.gitanyowfisheries.com

Kispiox River:

Water conditions in the Kispiox River, reflective of Drought Management considerations, will be communicated throughout the season.

Area 6

Net Fisheries:

Area A

No opportunities were determined for the 2026 season.

CSAF Demonstration Fisheries

One CSAF demonstration fishery targeting Area 6 Pink salmon was included in the 2026 draft IFMP. It is not expected that this fishery will proceed this season.



Areas 7 to 10 - Central Coast

Net Fisheries:

There have been five, 24-hour Chinook-directed commercial gill net fisheries in Area 8 to date this season, held on June 1, 8, 15, 22 and 29. Preliminary catch estimates for the Area C gill net fishery are provided below.

The Nuxalk demonstration fishery was opened for 24 hours on July 2, 2026; preliminary catch information is forthcoming. There are no further Chinook-directed commercial gill net openings planned.



Fishery Operations System

Commercial SALMON GILL NET In-Season Estimated Catch-by-Area (Pieces) for Area C (Central) and for Period 01-Apr-2026 to 10-Aug-2026

Management Area 8

Management Area 8

Report Details by Subarea or Portion

Stat Week	Week of Year	Date	Effort	Sockeye Salmon Kept	Sockeye Salmon Rel	Coho Salmon Kept	Coho Salmon Rel	Pink Salmon Kept	Pink Salmon Rel	Chum Salmon Kept	Chum Salmon Rel	Chinook Salmon Kept	Chinook Salmon Rel	Steelhead Kept	Steelhead Rel	Status	Last Updated
		01-Jun	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	6	0	0	0	Preliminary	03-Jun-2026
		Total for Week	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	6	0	0	0		
		08-Jun	4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	2	23	0	0	0	Preliminary	11-Jun-2026
		Total for Week	4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	2	23	0	0	0		
		15-Jun	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	31	27	0	0	0	Preliminary	18-Jun-2026
		Total for Week	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	31	27	0	0	0		
		22-Jun	9	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	424	124	0	0	0	Preliminary	25-Jun-2026
		Total for Week	9	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	424	124	0	0	0		
		29-Jun	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	416	48	0	0	0	Preliminary	02-Jul-2026
		Total for Week	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	416	48	0	0	0		
		Total for Management Area 8 in Period	26	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	873	228	0	0	0		

Notes:

1. Consult the applicable Fishery Manager or Biologist as to the status of particular catch estimates.

Printed from the Fishery Operations System on August 10, 2026 at 10:14

Central Coast Recreational Fisheries:

As per FN0687; Effective July 10, 2026 at 00:01 hours until 23:59 hours on August 17, 2026. The daily limit for Chinook is zero (0) per day in the tidal waters of Subareas 9-3 to 9-9.

The Heiltsuk, Kitsoo Xai'xais, Nuxalk, and Wuikinuxv Nations, with the coordination of the Central Coast Indigenous Resource Alliance (CCIRA) continue to collect data through a creel survey and DNA sampling program. The program will assess recreational and First Nations'



Food, Social, and Ceremonial (FSC) fisheries in marine portions of Areas 6 to 9. Survey work will occur through September 2026. Recreational and Indigenous fishers should be aware that they may be approached by creel surveyors from the Nations to collect important data from these fisheries.